In Princeton, Wheeler was intrigued at first, but was not fully convinced. He would become convinced only gradually, over the next several years. He was slower than Landau or Penrose, I believe, because he was looking deeper. He was fixated on his vision that quantum gravity must make nucleons (neutrons and protons) in an imploding star dissolve away into radiation and escape the implosion, and it seemed impossible to reconcile this vision with Finkelstein's insight. Nevertheless, as we shall see later, in a certain deep sense both Wheeler's vision and Finkelstein's insight were correct.

So just what was Finkelstein's insight? Finkelstein discovered, somewhat by chance and in just two lines of mathematics, a new reference frame in which to describe Schwarzschild's spacetime geometry. Finkelstein was not motivated by the implosion of stars and he did not make the connection between his new reference frame and stellar implosion. However, to others the implication of his new reference frame was clear. It gave them a totally new perspective on stellar implosion.